

Germany 'under threat,' Merz says after another explosive drone found near airport

送信者: POLITICO Pro Article 受信日時: 2026-08-25 18:22

[【メール原文】](#)

Explosive drones found near Leipzig airport show Germany is "under threat," Chancellor Friedrich Merz said Tuesday after the reported discovery of ano

Pro is better in the app.

[Click here to download.](#)

Germany 'under threat,' Merz says after another explosive drone found near airport

By Jules Darmanin · Aug 25, 2026, 11:21 AM · [View in your browser](#)

Explosive drones found near Leipzig airport show Germany is "under threat," Chancellor Friedrich Merz said Tuesday after the reported discovery of another device.

"The drone attack in Leipzig, among other things, shows that we are also facing very real threats. Germany has come under increased scrutiny from hybrid attackers," Merz said in remarks ahead of a cabinet retreat in Neuhausen.

German counterterrorism authorities opened an investigation on Aug. 5 after an airport worker found a drone carrying an explosive device on which the detonator apparently failed. Investigators found another drone on Aug. 14 near the Leipzig airport, an important logistics base for NATO, the Süddeutsche Zeitung outlet reported Tuesday .

Merz did not attribute the attack in his remarks Tuesday. "We are working intensively on that together with the security agencies, and we will present our findings and comment on them shortly," he said.

According to German outlet Bild , Merz told members of his Christian Democratic Union party in a private meeting Monday that the government had "circumstantial evidence pointing to the perpetrators of the crime."

Earlier this month, German Interior Minister Alexander Dobrindt suggested a state actor was behind the threat. "Many indications pointing in that direction," he said on Aug. 6 , shortly after the initial discovery.

Merz's government is seeking to give more leeway to Germany's intelligence services to stymie threats from adversaries such as Russia. Germany's security "worsened significantly" since Russian President Vladimir Putin ordered the full-scale invasion of Ukraine in February 2022, a German intelligence report said last year .

Spies working for Germany's foreign intelligence agency, the BND, could carry out acts of sabotage and conduct offensive cyber operations under proposed reforms.

Politics Mobility Defense

Airports Drones Espionage Military Security Friedrich Merz Germany

This email alert has been sent for your exclusive use as a POLITICO Pro subscriber. Forwarding or reproducing the article without the express, written permission of POLITICO Pro is a violation of the

POLITICO Pro license agreement.

This email was sent to shondo@iies.co.jp

[Update settings](#) | [Unsubscribe from this email](#) | [Unsubscribe from all emails](#)

POLITICO SRL · Rue de la Loi 62 · Brussels 1040 · Belgium